



René Magritte, *The False Mirror* (1929)

PSYCHOSOCIAL RESEARCH ROUNDS

# Pilot Test of the Digital Culture Interview: A novel method for assessing the digital habits of youth receiving mental health care

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Session chaired by Vincent Paquin, MD

**January 14, 2027**

1:30 PM – 2:00 PM (ET)

ICFP Amphitheatre, 4333 Côte-St-Catherine Rd., Montreal QC H3T 1E4

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## Learning objectives

- Reflect on the importance of addressing digital culture in mental health clinical practice.
- Understand the role of the Digital Culture Interview in exploring patients' digital practices in mental health care.
- Describe clinicians' and patients' perceptions of the utility, feasibility and acceptability of the Digital Culture Interview.

## Abstract

Young adults and adolescents are the largest users of digital media in Canada, often spending more than 20 hours weekly online. Although excessive "screen time" may be harmful, digital media may also offer benefits. However, clinicians lack evidence-based methods to assess the impact of digital media in mental health care.

This study aims to evaluate a novel semi-structured interview - the Digital Culture Interview (DCI) - designed to help clinicians assess the digital habits of youth receiving mental health care. Ten youth aged 16–35 years receiving mental health care in Montreal, Canada, were recruited.

Participants first completed an interview during which the DCI was administered. Approximately one week later, they completed a debriefing interview to provide feedback on the DCI. Debriefing interviews were analyzed using reflexive thematic analysis.

Participants highlighted the lack of tailored questions on digital technologies in routine clinical practice. As a result, they perceived the DCI as a refreshing approach and found its questions appropriate. Participants emphasized that the interview allowed them to share more about their interests, enabling clinicians to gain a deeper understanding of them. It also encouraged participants to reflect on their digital habits, sometimes prompting discussions about meaningful digital experiences or behaviors that they continued to think about afterward.

However, several participants noted that questions about digital culture may be less relevant for patients whose mental health concerns are unrelated to digital technologies. Overall, participants perceived the DCI as a valuable tool for facilitating discussions about digital media in mental health care.

## About

Anis Boukhari is a second-year medical student at McGill University. He joined Dr. Vincent Paquin's Digital Culture and Mental Health Laboratory in 2026 as a recipient of a McGill Summer Research Bursary

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